

School-Wide Systems & Policy

Learner guide | SWP-021 | School of School Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for School-Wide Systems & Policy. By the end of the course, you should be able to influence school climate, procedures, and policy using social-work and equity principles.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Influence school climate, procedures, and policy using social-work and equity principles.
- Apply the key ideas from School systems and climate.
- Apply the key ideas from Policy analysis and improvement.
- Apply the key ideas from Whole-school change.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. School systems and climate	discipline, inclusion, wellbeing, safeguarding, and data-informed problem identification	10 to 15 minutes
2. Policy analysis and improvement	stakeholders, equity impact, implementation planning, and communication	10 to 15 minutes
3. Whole-school change	restorative practices, multi-tiered systems, evaluation, and sustaining change	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 School systems and climate

This module focuses on discipline, inclusion, wellbeing, safeguarding, and data-informed problem identification. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Discipline
- Inclusion
- Wellbeing
- Safeguarding
- Data-informed problem identification

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of school systems and climate in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of discipline, inclusion, wellbeing, safeguarding, and data-informed problem identification. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through school systems and climate safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Policy analysis and improvement

This module focuses on stakeholders, equity impact, implementation planning, and communication. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Stakeholders
- Equity impact
- Implementation planning
- Communication

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of policy analysis and improvement in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of stakeholders, equity impact, implementation planning, and communication. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through policy analysis and improvement safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Whole-school change

This module focuses on restorative practices, multi-tiered systems, evaluation, and sustaining change. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Restorative practices
- Multi-tiered systems
- Evaluation
- Sustaining change

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of whole-school change in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of restorative practices, multi-tiered systems, evaluation, and sustaining change. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through whole-school change safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: systems thinking.
- Review the distinction between: equity impacts.
- Review the distinction between: implementation.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.